

Software Design Document

Title page (Project title, group name, members)

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1. Introduction - Provide an overview of the SDD and a description of the scope of the software.
 1. Purpose - define the purpose of this SDD and specify intended readership.
 2. Scope - identify the software products to be produced by name; explain what the proposed software will do (and not do, if necessary); describe the relevant benefits, objectives and goals as precisely as possible; and be consistent with related higher-level specifications.
 3. Definitions, Acronyms, and Abbreviations - provide definitions of all terms, acronyms and abbreviations needed for the SDD.
 4. References - provide a complete list of all the applicable and referenced documents.
 5. Overview - describe what the rest of the SDD contains and explain how the SDD is organized.
2. System Overview - Briefly introduce the system context and design, and discuss the background to the project.
3. System Design
 1. Design method - Describe the design method used.
 2. Decomposition description - Summarize the software components, including the hierarchy and control and data flows.
4. Component Description - A top-down description of the design components.
 1. Component identifier - An identifier unique throughout the SDD.
 1. Type - the logical (e.g., class or library) and physical (e.g., subroutine, file) characteristics.
 2. Purpose - A reference back to the requirements spec.
 3. Function - What does the component do?
 4. Subordinates - The components used by this component.
 5. Dependencies - Constraints placed on this component by other components.
 6. Interfaces - Control and data flow into and out of the component.
 7. Data - Descriptions of internal data.